

Understanding audio (or signed) media and recordings

This scale involves broadcast audio and signed media and recorded materials unaccompanied by video, including messages, weather forecasts, narrated stories, news bulletins, interviews and documentaries. Key concepts operationalised in the scale include the following:

- ▶ picking out concrete information;
- ▶ understanding main points, essential information;
- ▶ catching important information;
- ▶ identifying speaker mood, attitudes and viewpoints.

	Understanding audio (or signed) media and recordings
C2	<i>No descriptors available; see C1</i>
C1	Can understand a wide range of recorded and broadcast material, including some non-standard usage, and identify finer points of detail including implicit attitudes and relationships between people.
B2	Can understand recordings in the standard form of the language likely to be encountered in social, professional or academic life and identify viewpoints and attitudes as well as the information content. Can understand most documentaries and most other recorded or broadcast material delivered in the standard form of the language and can identify mood, attitude, etc.
B1	Can understand the information content of the majority of recorded or broadcast material on topics of personal interest delivered in clear standard language. Can understand the main points of news bulletins and simpler recorded material about familiar subjects delivered relatively slowly and clearly. Can understand the main points and important details in stories and other narratives (e.g. a description of a holiday), provided the delivery is slow and clear.
A2	Can understand the most important information contained in short commercials concerning goods and services of interest (e.g. CDs, video games, travel). Can understand in an interview what people say they do in their free time, what they particularly like doing and what they do not like doing, provided they speak slowly and clearly. Can understand and extract the essential information from short, recorded passages dealing with predictable everyday matters which are delivered slowly and clearly. Can extract important information from short broadcasts (e.g. the weather forecast, concert announcements, sports results), provided people talk clearly. Can understand the important points of a story and manage to follow the plot, provided the story is told slowly and clearly.
A1	Can pick out concrete information (e.g. places and times) from short recordings on familiar everyday topics, provided they are delivered very slowly and clearly.
Pre-A1	Can recognise words/signs, names and numbers that they already know in simple, short recordings, provided these are delivered very slowly and clearly.

3.1.1.2. Audio-visual comprehension

Watching TV, film and video

This scale includes live and recorded video material plus, at higher levels, film. Key concepts operationalised in the scale include the following:

- ▶ following changes of topic and identifying main points;
- ▶ identifying details, nuances and implied meaning (C levels);
- ▶ delivery: from slow, clear standard usage to the ability to handle slang and idiomatic usage.

	Watching TV, film and video
C2	<i>No descriptors available; see C1</i>
C1	Can follow films employing a considerable degree of slang and idiomatic usage. Can understand in detail the arguments presented in demanding television broadcasts such as current affairs programmes, interviews, discussion programmes and chat shows. Can understand nuances and implied meaning in most films, plays and TV programmes, provided these are delivered in standard language or a familiar variety.
B2	Can extract the main points from the arguments and discussions in news and current affairs programmes. Can understand most TV news and current affairs programmes. Can understand documentaries, live interviews, talk shows, plays and the majority of films in the standard form of the language or a familiar variety.
B1	Can understand a large part of many TV programmes on topics of personal interest such as interviews, short lectures and news reports when the delivery is relatively slow and clear. Can follow many films in which visuals and action carry much of the storyline, and which are delivered clearly in straightforward language. Can catch the main points in TV programmes on familiar topics when the delivery is relatively slow and clear.
A2	Can identify the main point of TV news items reporting events, accidents, etc. where the visuals support the commentary. Can follow a TV commercial or a trailer for or scene from a film, understanding what topic(s) are concerned, provided the images are a great help in understanding and the delivery is clear and relatively slow. Can follow changes of topic of factual TV news items, and form an idea of the main content.
A1	Can recognise familiar words/signs and phrases and identify the topics in headline news summaries and many of the products in advertisements, by exploiting visual information and general knowledge.
Pre-A1	Can identify the subject of a video document on the basis of visual information and previous knowledge.

3.1.1.3. Reading comprehension

Reading comprehension is taken to include both written and signed texts. The categories for reading are a mixture between reading purpose and reading particular genres with specific functions. In terms of reading purpose, there is a fundamental difference between “Reading for orientation” and “Reading for information and argument”. The former is sometimes called search reading and mainly takes two forms: firstly, reading a text “diagonally” at speed in order to decide whether to read (parts of) it properly (= “skimming”), and secondly, looking quickly through a text, searching for something specific – usually a piece of information (= “scanning”). The latter is the way one reads artefacts like bus or train timetables, but sometimes one searches through a long prose text looking for something in particular. Then there is a fundamental difference between “Reading for information and argument” and “Reading as a leisure activity”. The latter may well involve non-fiction, but not necessarily literature. It will also encompass magazines and newspapers, vlogs/blogs, biographies, etc. – and possibly even texts that another person would read only for work or study purposes, depending on one’s interests. Finally, there are texts that one reads in a particular way – like “Reading instructions”, a specialised form of reading for information. “Reading correspondence” is different again, and this is offered first since the scales start in each category with interpersonal language use. “Reading as a leisure activity” is listed last purely because it was added in 2018.

Overall reading comprehension

	Overall reading comprehension
C2	Can understand virtually all types of texts including abstract, structurally complex, or highly colloquial literary and non-literary writings. Can understand a wide range of long and complex texts, appreciating subtle distinctions of style and implicit as well as explicit meaning.
C1	Can understand in detail lengthy, complex texts, whether or not these relate to their own area of speciality, provided they can reread difficult sections. Can understand a wide variety of texts including literary writings, newspaper or magazine articles, and specialised academic or professional publications, provided there are opportunities for rereading and they have access to reference tools.
B2	Can read with a large degree of independence, adapting style and speed of reading to different texts and purposes, and using appropriate reference sources selectively. Has a broad active reading vocabulary, but may experience some difficulty with low-frequency idioms.
B1	Can read straightforward factual texts on subjects related to their field of interest with a satisfactory level of comprehension.
A2	Can understand short, simple texts on familiar matters of a concrete type which consist of high frequency everyday or job-related language. Can understand short, simple texts containing the highest frequency vocabulary, including a proportion of shared international vocabulary items.
A1	Can understand very short, simple texts a single phrase at a time, picking up familiar names, words and basic phrases and rereading as required.
Pre-A1	Can recognise familiar words/signs accompanied by pictures, such as a fast-food restaurant menu illustrated with photos or a picture book using familiar vocabulary.

Reading correspondence

This scale encompasses reading both personal and formal correspondence. Key concepts operationalised in the scale include the following:

- ▶ length and complexity/simplicity of message;
- ▶ concreteness of information, whether it follows a routine format;
- ▶ the extent to which language is standard, colloquial, idiomatic;
- ▶ the extent to which the subject is an everyday one, or if it is related to interests, or specialised.

	Reading correspondence
C2	Can understand specialised, formal correspondence on a complex topic.
C1	Can understand any correspondence given the occasional use of a dictionary. Can understand implicit as well as explicit attitudes, emotions and opinions expressed in e-mails, discussion forums, vlogs/blogs, etc., provided there are opportunities for rereading and they have access to reference tools. Can understand slang, idiomatic expressions and jokes in private correspondence.
B2	Can read correspondence relating to their field of interest and readily grasp the essential meaning. Can understand what is said in a personal e-mail or posting even where some colloquial language is used.

	Reading correspondence
B1	Can understand formal correspondence on less familiar subjects well enough to redirect it to someone else.
	Can understand the description of events, feelings and wishes in personal letters well enough to correspond regularly with a pen friend.
	Can understand straightforward personal letters, e-mails or postings giving a relatively detailed account of events and experiences.
	Can understand standard formal correspondence and online postings in their area of professional interest.
A2	Can understand a simple personal letter, e-mail or post in which the person writing is talking about familiar subjects (such as friends or family) or asking questions on these subjects.
	Can understand basic types of standard routine letters and faxes (enquiries, orders, letters of confirmation, etc.) on familiar topics.
	Can understand short, simple personal letters. Can understand very simple formal e-mails and letters (e.g. confirmation of a booking or online purchase).
A1	Can understand short, simple messages on postcards.
	Can understand short, simple messages sent via social media or e-mail (e.g. proposing what to do, when and where to meet).
Pre-A1	Can understand from a letter, card or e-mail the event to which they are being invited and the information given about day, time and location.
	Can recognise times and places in very simple notes and text messages from friends or colleagues (e.g. "Back at 4 o'clock" or "In the meeting room"), provided there are no abbreviations.

Reading for orientation

Reading for orientation – search reading – involves “skimming”: reading at speed in order to judge relevance and “scanning”: searching for specific information. In relation to signed texts, both functions are achieved by putting the video into “fast forward”. Key concepts operationalised in the scale include the following:

- ▶ the types of text (from notices, leaflets, etc. to articles and books);
- ▶ picking out concrete information like times and prices from texts that are visual artefacts, rather than prose text, with helpful layout;
- ▶ identifying important information;
- ▶ scanning prose text for relevance;
- ▶ speed, mentioned in B2.

	Reading for orientation
C2	<i>No descriptors available; see B2</i>
C1	<i>No descriptors available; see B2</i>
B2	Can scan quickly through several sources (articles, reports, websites, books, etc.) in parallel, in both their own field and in related fields, and can identify the relevance and usefulness of particular sections for the task at hand.
	Can scan quickly through long and complex texts, locating relevant details.
	Can quickly identify the content and relevance of news items, articles and reports on a wide range of professional topics, deciding whether closer study is worthwhile.

	Reading for orientation
B1	Can scan longer texts in order to locate desired information, and gather information from different parts of a text, or from different texts in order to fulfil a specific task. Can scan through straightforward, factual texts in magazines, brochures or on the web, identify what they are about and decide whether they contain information that might be of practical use.
	Can find and understand relevant information in everyday material, such as letters, brochures and short official documents. Can pick out important information about preparation and usage on the labels on foodstuff and medicine. Can assess whether an article, report or review is on the required topic. Can understand the important information in simple, clearly drafted adverts in newspapers or magazines, provided there are not too many abbreviations.
A2	Can find specific information in practical, concrete, predictable texts (e.g. travel guidebooks, recipes), provided they are produced in simple language. Can understand the main information in short and simple descriptions of goods in brochures and websites (e.g. portable digital devices, cameras).
	Can find specific, predictable information in simple everyday material such as advertisements, prospectuses, menus, reference lists and timetables. Can locate specific information in lists and isolate the information required (e.g. use the Yellow Pages to find a service or tradesman). Can understand everyday signs and notices, etc. in public places, such as streets, restaurants, railway stations; in workplaces, such as directions, instructions, hazard warnings.
A1	Can recognise familiar names, words/signs and very basic phrases on simple notices in the most common everyday situations. Can understand store guides (information on which floors departments are on) and directions (e.g. where to find lifts). Can understand basic hotel information (e.g. times when meals are served). Can find and understand simple, important information in advertisements, programmes for special events, leaflets and brochures (e.g. what is proposed, costs, the date and place of the event, departure times).
	Can understand simple everyday signs such as "Parking", "Station", "Dining room", "No smoking", etc. Can find information about places, times and prices on posters, flyers and notices.
Pre-A1	

Reading for information and argument

Reading for information and argument – detailed reading – involves careful study of a written or signed text that one has judged to be relevant for a purpose at hand. It is often associated with study and professional life. Key concepts operationalised in the scale include the following:

- ▶ types of text, from simple, short, illustrated informational material to complex reports and articles;
- ▶ subjects of text, from familiar everyday subjects of personal interest to topics outside their area of interest;
- ▶ depth of understanding, from getting an idea of the content to understanding the finer points and implications.

	Reading for information and argument
C2	Can understand the finer points and implications of a complex report or article even outside their area of specialisation.
C1	Can understand in detail a wide range of lengthy, complex texts likely to be encountered in social, professional or academic life, identifying finer points of detail including attitudes and implied as well as stated opinions.

	Reading for information and argument
B2	Can obtain information, ideas and opinions from highly specialised sources within their field. Can understand specialised articles outside their field, provided they can use a dictionary occasionally to confirm their interpretation of terminology.
	Can understand articles and reports concerned with contemporary problems in which particular stances or viewpoints are adopted. Can recognise when a text provides factual information and when it seeks to convince readers of something. Can recognise different structures in discursive text: contrasting arguments, problem–solution presentation and cause–effect relationships.
B1	Can understand straightforward, factual texts on subjects relating to their interests or studies. Can understand short texts on subjects that are familiar or of current interest, in which people give their points of view (e.g. critical contributions to an online discussion forum or readers’ letters to the editor). Can identify the main conclusions in clearly signalled argumentative texts. Can recognise the line of argument in the treatment of the issue presented, though not necessarily in detail.
	Can recognise significant points in straightforward news articles on familiar subjects. Can understand most factual information that they are likely to come across on familiar subjects of interest, provided they have sufficient time for rereading. Can understand the main points in descriptive notes such as those on museum exhibits and explanatory boards in exhibitions.
A2	Can identify specific information in simpler material they encounter such as letters, brochures and short news articles describing events. Can follow the general outline of a news report on a familiar type of event, provided the contents are familiar and predictable. Can pick out the main information in short news reports or simple articles in which figures, names, illustrations and titles play a prominent role and support the meaning of the text. Can understand the main points of short texts dealing with everyday topics (e.g. lifestyle, hobbies, sports, weather).
	Can understand texts describing people, places, everyday life and culture, etc., provided they use simple language. Can understand information given in illustrated brochures and maps (e.g. the principal attractions of a city). Can understand the main points in short news items on subjects of personal interest (e.g. sport, celebrities). Can understand a short factual description or report within their own field, provided simple language is used and that it does not contain unpredictable detail. Can understand most of what people say about themselves in a personal ad or post and what they say they like in other people.
A1	Can get an idea of the content of simpler informational material and short, simple descriptions, especially if there is visual support. Can understand short texts on subjects of personal interest (e.g. news flashes about sports, music, travel or stories) composed in very simple language and supported by illustrations and pictures.
Pre-A1	Can understand the simplest informational material such as a fast-food restaurant menu illustrated with photos or an illustrated story formulated in very simple everyday words/signs.

Reading instructions

Reading instructions is a specialised form of reading for information, and again concerns written or signed text. Key concepts operationalised in the scale include the following:

- ▶ topic of instructions, from routine prohibitions on simple notices and simple directions to detailed conditions and complex instructions on something unfamiliar, possibly outside their area of expertise;
- ▶ degree of contextualisation and familiarity;
- ▶ length, from a few words/signs to detailed and lengthy, complex instructions in continuous text.

	Reading instructions
C2	<i>No descriptors available; see C1</i>
C1	Can understand in detail lengthy, complex instructions on a new machine or procedure, whether or not the instructions relate to their own area of speciality, provided they can reread difficult sections.
B2	Can understand lengthy, complex instructions in their field, including details on conditions and warnings, provided they can reread difficult sections.
B1	Can understand instructions and procedures in the form of a continuous text, for instance in a manual, provided they are familiar with the type of process or product concerned.
	Can understand clearly expressed, straightforward instructions for a piece of equipment.
	Can follow simple instructions given on packaging (e.g. cooking instructions). Can understand most short safety instructions, (e.g. on public transport or in manuals for the use of electrical equipment).
A2	Can understand regulations, for example safety, when expressed in simple language. Can understand short instructions illustrated step by step (e.g. for installing new technology).
	Can understand simple instructions on equipment encountered in everyday life – such as a public telephone.
	Can understand simple, brief instructions, provided they are illustrated and not presented in continuous text.
	Can understand instructions on medicine labels expressed as a simple command (e.g. “Take before meals” or “Do not take if driving”). Can follow a simple recipe, especially if there are pictures to illustrate the most important steps.
A1	Can follow short, simple directions (e.g. to go from X to Y).
Pre-A1	Can understand very short, simple, instructions used in familiar everyday contexts (e.g. “No parking”, “No food or drink”), especially if there are illustrations.

Reading as a leisure activity

This scale involves both fiction and non-fiction written and signed texts. These may include creative texts, different forms of literature, magazine and newspaper articles, blogs or biographies, among other types of text – depending on one’s interests. Key concepts operationalised in the scale include the following:

- ▶ length, variety of texts and whether there are illustrations;
- ▶ types of text, from simple descriptions of people and places, through different types of narrative text, to contemporary and classical writings in different genres;
- ▶ topics, from everyday topics (for example hobbies, sports, leisure activities, animals) and concrete situations to a full range of abstract and literary topics;
- ▶ type of language: from simple to stylistically complex;
- ▶ ease of reading: from guessing with the help of images, through reading with a large degree of independence to appreciating the variety of texts;
- ▶ depth of understanding: from understanding in outline/the main points to understanding implicit as well as explicit meaning.

	Reading as a leisure activity
C2	Can read virtually all forms of texts including classical or colloquial literary and non-literary texts in different genres, appreciating subtle distinctions of style and implicit as well as explicit meaning.
C1	Can read and appreciate a variety of literary texts, provided they can reread certain sections and that they can access reference tools if they wish. Can read contemporary literary texts and non-fiction produced in the standard form of the language or a familiar variety with little difficulty and with appreciation of implicit meanings and ideas.
B2	Can read for pleasure with a large degree of independence, adapting style and speed of reading to different texts (e.g. magazines, more straightforward novels, history books, biographies, travelogues, guides, lyrics, poems), using appropriate reference sources selectively. Can read novels with a strong, narrative plot and that use straightforward, unelaborated language, provided they can take their time and use a dictionary.
B1	Can read newspaper/magazine accounts of films, books, concerts, etc. produced for a wider audience and understand the main points. Can understand simple poems and song lyrics provided these employ straightforward language and style. Can understand descriptions of places, events, explicitly expressed feelings and perspectives in narratives, guides and magazine articles that employ high frequency everyday language. Can understand a travel diary mainly describing the events of a journey and the experiences and discoveries of the writer. Can follow the plot of stories, simple novels and comics with a clear linear storyline and high frequency everyday language, given regular use of a dictionary.
A2	Can understand enough to read short, simple stories and comic strips involving familiar, concrete situations described in high frequency everyday language. Can understand the main points made in short magazine reports or guide entries that deal with concrete everyday topics (e.g. hobbies, sports, leisure activities, animals). Can understand short narratives and descriptions of someone's life composed in simple language. Can understand what is happening in a photo story (e.g. in a lifestyle magazine) and form an impression of what the characters are like. Can understand much of the information provided in a short description of a person (e.g. a celebrity). Can understand the main point of a short article reporting an event that follows a predictable pattern (e.g. the Oscars), provided it is composed clearly in simple language.
A1	Can understand short, illustrated narratives about everyday activities described in simple words. Can understand in outline short texts in illustrated stories, provided the images help them to guess at a lot of the content.
Pre-A1	<i>No descriptors available</i>

3.1.2. Reception strategies

In reception, understanding progresses through a combination of bottom-up/top-down processing and the use of content and formal schemata in inferencing. One scale is provided for the inferencing strategies that this involves. Key concepts operationalised in the scale include the following:

- ▶ exploiting illustrations, formatting, headings, subtitles, position in the text, etc.;
- ▶ deducing meaning from the co-text and linguistic context;
- ▶ exploiting linguistic clues: from numbers and proper nouns, through word/sign roots, prefixes and suffixes, temporal connectors and logical connectors, to skilled use of a variety of strategies.

Identifying cues and inferring (spoken, signed and written)

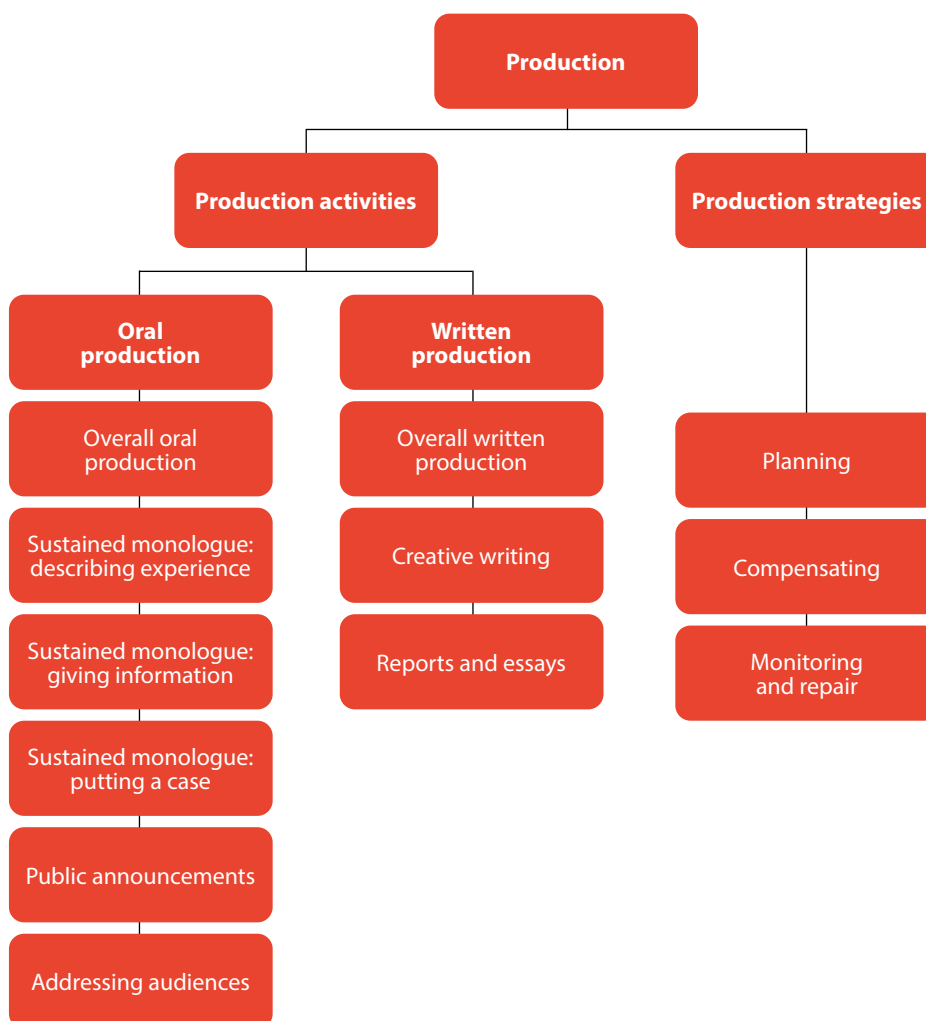
	Identifying cues and inferring (spoken, signed and written)
C2	<i>No descriptors available; see C1</i>
C1	Is skilled at using contextual, grammatical and lexical cues to infer attitude, mood and intentions and anticipate what will come next.
B2	Can use a variety of strategies to achieve comprehension, including watching out for main points and checking comprehension by using contextual clues.
B1	Can exploit different types of connectors (numerical, temporal, logical) and the role of key paragraphs in the overall organisation in order to better understand the argumentation in a text. Can extrapolate the meaning of a section of a text by taking into account the text as a whole. Can identify the meaning of unfamiliar words/signs from the context on topics related to their field and interests. Can extrapolate the meaning of occasional unknown words/signs from the context and deduce sentence meaning, provided the topic discussed is familiar. Can make basic inferences or predictions about text content from headings, titles or headlines. Can watch or listen to a short narrative and predict what will happen next. Can follow a line of argumentation or the sequence of events in a story, by focusing on common logical connectors (e.g. however, because) and temporal connectors (e.g. after that, beforehand). Can deduce the probable meaning of unknown words/signs in a text by identifying their constituent parts (e.g. identifying roots, lexical elements, suffixes and prefixes).
A2	Can use an idea of the overall meaning of short texts and utterances on everyday topics of a concrete type to derive the probable meaning of unknown words/signs from the context. Can exploit their recognition of known words/signs to deduce the meaning of unfamiliar words/signs in short expressions used in routine everyday contexts. Can exploit format, appearance and typographic features in order to identify the type of text: news story, promotional text, article, textbook, chat or forum, etc. Can exploit numbers, dates, names, proper nouns, etc. to identify the topic of a text. Can deduce the meaning and function of unknown formulaic expressions from their position in a text (e.g. at the beginning or end of a letter).
A1	Can deduce the meaning of an unknown word/sign for a concrete action or object, provided the surrounding text is very simple, and on a familiar everyday subject. Can guess the probable meaning of an unknown word/sign that is similar to one in the language they normally use.
Pre-A1	Can deduce the meaning of a word/sign from an accompanying picture or icon.

3.2. PRODUCTION

Production includes speaking, signing and writing activities. Oral production is a “long turn”, which may involve a short description or anecdote, or may imply a longer, more formal presentation. Productive activities have an important function in many academic and professional fields (for example oral presentations, written studies and reports – that may be transmitted in sign) and particular social value is attached to them. Judgments are made about the linguistic quality of what has been submitted in writing or in a signed video, and about the

fluency and articulateness of expression in real time, especially when addressing an audience. Ability in this more formal production is not acquired naturally; it is a product of literacy learnt through education and experience. It involves learning the expectations and conventions of the genre concerned. Production strategies are employed to improve the quality of both informal and formal production. “Planning” is obviously more associated with formal genres, but “Monitoring and compensating” for gaps in vocabulary or terminology are also quasi-automated processes in natural language production.

Figure 12 – Production activities and strategies



3.2.1. Production activities

3.2.1.1. Oral production

The categories for oral production are organised in terms of three macro-functions (interpersonal, transactional, evaluative), with two more specialised genres: “Addressing audiences” and “Public announcements”. “Sustained monologue: describing experience” focuses mainly on descriptions and narratives while “Sustained monologue: putting a case (e.g. in a debate)” describes the ability to sustain an argument, which may well be made in a long turn in the context of normal conversation and discussion. “Sustained monologue: giving information” is a new 2018 scale, created by transferring certain descriptors from the scale for “Information exchange” that implied monologue rather than dialogue.

Overall oral production

	Overall oral production
C2	Can produce clear, smoothly flowing, well-structured discourse with an effective logical structure which helps the recipient to notice and remember significant points.
C1	Can give clear, detailed descriptions and presentations on complex subjects, integrating sub-themes, developing particular points and rounding off with an appropriate conclusion.
B2	Can give clear, systematically developed descriptions and presentations, with appropriate highlighting of significant points, and relevant supporting detail.
	Can give clear, detailed descriptions and presentations on a wide range of subjects related to their field of interest, expanding and supporting ideas with subsidiary points and relevant examples.
B1	Can reasonably fluently sustain a straightforward description of one of a variety of subjects within their field of interest, presenting it as a linear sequence of points.
A2	Can give a simple description or presentation of people, living or working conditions, daily routines, likes/dislikes, etc. as a short series of simple phrases and sentences linked into a list.
A1	Can produce simple, mainly isolated phrases about people and places.
Pre-A1	Can produce short phrases about themselves, giving basic personal information (e.g. name, address, family, nationality).

Sustained monologue: describing experience

This scale concerns narrative and description. It has many short descriptors from A1 to B1 reflecting a relatively direct link between communicative functions and the language used to express them. There is little or no information about quality of language, for which one needs to consult the scales for communicative language competences, which are relevant to spoken, signed and written modalities. Key concepts operationalised in the scale include the following:

- ▶ aspects described, from simple everyday information (describe themselves, what they do and where they live), through classic functions (for example, describe plans and arrangements, habits and routines, past activities and personal experiences) and a wide range of subjects related to fields of interest, to detailed descriptions of complex subjects;
- ▶ complexity of discourse: from simple words/signs, formulaic expressions and simple sentences or short paragraphs, through relating as a sequence of points, to integrating sub-themes and developing particular points in a smoothly flowing description.

	Sustained monologue: describing experience
C2	Can give clear, smoothly flowing, elaborate and often memorable descriptions.
C1	Can give clear, detailed descriptions of complex subjects.
	Can give elaborate descriptions and narratives, integrating sub-themes, developing particular points and rounding them off with an appropriate conclusion.
B2	Can give clear, detailed descriptions on a wide range of subjects related to their field of interest.
	Can describe the personal significance of events and experiences in detail.
B1	Can clearly express feelings about something experienced and give reasons to explain those feelings.
	Can give straightforward descriptions on a variety of familiar subjects within their field of interest.
	Can reasonably fluently relate a straightforward narrative or description as a sequence of points.
	Can give detailed accounts of experiences, describing feelings and reactions.
	Can relate details of unpredictable occurrences, e.g. an accident.
	Can relate the plot of a book or film and describe their reactions.
	Can describe dreams, hopes and ambitions.
	Can describe events, real or imagined.
	Can narrate a story.

	Sustained monologue: describing experience
A2	Can tell a story or describe something in a simple list of points. Can describe everyday aspects of their environment, e.g. people, places, a job or study experience. Can give short, basic descriptions of events and activities. Can describe plans and arrangements, habits and routines, past activities and personal experiences. Can use simple descriptive language to make brief statements about and compare objects and possessions. Can explain what they like or dislike about something.
A1	Can describe their family, living conditions, educational background, present or most recent job. Can describe people, places and possessions in simple terms. Can express what they are good at and not so good at (e.g. sports, games, skills, subjects). Can briefly describe what they plan to do at the weekend or during the holidays.
Pre-A1	Can describe themselves, what they do and where they live. Can describe simple aspects of their everyday life in a series of simple sentences, using simple words/signs and basic phrases, provided they can prepare in advance.
Pre-A1	Can describe themselves (e.g. name, age, family), using simple words/signs and formulaic expressions, provided they can prepare in advance. Can express how they are feeling using simple adjectives like “happy” or “tired”, accompanied by body language.

Sustained monologue: giving information

Sustained monologue: giving information is a new scale concerned with explaining information to a recipient in a long turn. Although the recipient may well interrupt to ask for repetition and clarification, the information is clearly unidirectional; it is not an exchange. Key concepts operationalised in the scale include the following:

- ▶ type of information: from a simple description of an object, or directions, through straightforward factual information on a familiar topic, to complex professional or academic procedures;
- ▶ degree of precision: from simple descriptions, through explaining the main points with reasonable precision and communicating detailed information reliably, to making clear distinctions between ideas, concepts and things that closely resemble one another.

	Sustained monologue: giving information
C2	<i>No descriptors available; see C1</i>
C1	Can communicate clearly detailed distinctions between ideas, concepts and things that closely resemble one other. Can give instructions on carrying out a series of complex professional or academic procedures.
B2	Can communicate complex information and advice on the full range of matters related to their occupational role. Can communicate detailed information reliably. Can give a clear, detailed description of how to carry out a procedure.
B1	Can explain the main points in an idea or problem with reasonable precision. Can describe how to do something, giving detailed instructions. Can report straightforward factual information on a familiar topic, for example to indicate the nature of a problem or to give detailed directions, provided they can prepare beforehand.
A2	Can give simple directions on how to get from X to Y, using basic expressions such as “turn right” and “go straight”, along with sequential connectors such as “first”, “then” and “next”.
A1	Can name an object and indicate its shape and colour while showing it to others using basic words/signs, phrases and formulaic expressions, provided they can prepare in advance.
Pre-A1	<i>No descriptors available</i>

Sustained monologue: putting a case (e.g. in a debate)

This scale describes the ability to sustain an argument. The descriptors published in 2001 were bunched at B2, where this ability is a salient concept. Descriptors have now been added for more levels. Key concepts operationalised in the scale include the following:

- ▶ topics: from what they like or dislike about something, through opinions on subjects relating to everyday life, to topical issues and complex issues;
- ▶ manner of arguing: from making simple, direct comparisons, through expanding and supporting viewpoints at some length while developing an argument systematically, to taking into account the interlocutor's perspective and employing emphasis effectively;
- ▶ manner of formulation: from presenting an idea in simple terms to highlighting significant points appropriately and formulating points precisely in well-structured language.

	Sustained monologue: putting a case (e.g. in a debate)
C2	No descriptors available; see C1
C1	Can argue a case on a complex issue, formulating points precisely and employing emphasis effectively. Can develop an argument systematically in well-structured language, taking into account the interlocutor's perspective, highlighting significant points with supporting examples and concluding appropriately.
B2	Can develop an argument systematically with appropriate highlighting of significant points, and relevant supporting detail. Can develop a clear argument, expanding and supporting their points of view at some length with subsidiary points and relevant examples. Can construct a chain of reasoned argument. Can explain a viewpoint on a topical issue giving the advantages and disadvantages of various options.
B1	Can develop an argument well enough to be followed without difficulty most of the time. Can give simple reasons to justify a viewpoint on a familiar topic. Can express opinions on subjects relating to everyday life, using simple expressions. Can briefly give reasons and explanations for opinions, plans and actions. Can explain whether or not they approve of what someone has done and give reasons to justify this opinion.
A2	Can explain what they like or dislike about something, why they prefer one thing to another, making simple, direct comparisons. Can present their opinion in simple terms, provided interlocutors are patient.
A1	No descriptors available
Pre-A1	No descriptors available

Public announcements

Public announcements are a very specialised way of passing important information to a group of people, perhaps in a private capacity (for example at a wedding), perhaps while organising an event or outing, or in the manner of air cabin staff. Key concepts operationalised in the scale include the following:

- ▶ type of content: from predictable, learnt content to announcements on a range of topics;
- ▶ intelligibility: from a delivery that recipients will have to concentrate on to follow, to effective use of prosodic cues⁴¹ in order to convey finer shades of meaning precisely;
- ▶ need for preparation: from very short, rehearsed announcements to spontaneous and almost effortless fluency.

41. Prosodic cues are, for example, stress and intonation for spoken languages, and non-manual elements for sign languages.

	Public announcements
C2	<i>No descriptors available; see C1</i>
C1	Can deliver announcements fluently, almost effortlessly, using stress and intonation to convey finer shades of meaning precisely.
B2	Can deliver announcements on most general topics with a degree of clarity, fluency and spontaneity which causes no strain or inconvenience to the recipient.
B1	Can deliver short, rehearsed announcements on a topic pertinent to everyday occurrences in their field which, despite possible problems with stress and intonation (= non-manuals in a sign language), are nevertheless clearly intelligible.
A2	Can deliver very short, rehearsed announcements of predictable, learnt content which are intelligible to recipients who are prepared to concentrate.
A1	<i>No descriptors available</i>
Pre-A1	<i>No descriptors available</i>

Addressing audiences

This scale involves giving an oral presentation at a public event, in a meeting, seminar or class. Although the talk is clearly prepared, it is not usually read word for word/sign for sign. Nowadays it is conventional to use visual aids like PowerPoint, but this need not be the case. After a presentation, it is customary to take questions spontaneously, answering in a short monologue, so this is included in the descriptors as well. Key concepts operationalised in the scale include the following:

- ▶ type of address: from a very short, rehearsed statement, through a prepared, straightforward presentation on a familiar topic within their field, to a well-structured presentation on a complex subject given to an audience unfamiliar with it;
- ▶ consideration of the audience: there is no comment at the A levels, but from B1 the progression goes from being clear enough to be followed without difficulty most of the time, to structuring and adapting the talk flexibly to meet the needs of the audience;
- ▶ ability to handle questions: from answering straightforward questions with some help, through taking a series of follow-up questions fluently and spontaneously, to handling difficult and even hostile questioning.

	Addressing audiences
C2	Can present a complex topic confidently and articulately to an audience unfamiliar with it, structuring and adapting the talk flexibly to meet the audience's needs. Can handle difficult and even hostile questioning.
C1	Can give a clear, well-structured presentation on a complex subject, expanding and supporting points of view at some length with subsidiary points, reasons and relevant examples. Can structure a longer presentation appropriately in order to help the audience follow the sequence of ideas and understand the overall argumentation. Can speculate or hypothesise in presenting a complex subject, comparing and evaluating alternative proposals and arguments. Can handle interjections well, responding spontaneously and almost effortlessly.
B2	Can give a clear, systematically developed presentation, with highlighting of significant points, and relevant supporting detail. Can depart spontaneously from a prepared text and follow up interesting points raised by members of the audience, often showing remarkable fluency and ease of expression. Can give a clear, prepared presentation, giving reasons in support of or against a particular point of view and giving the advantages and disadvantages of various options. Can take a series of follow-up questions with a degree of fluency and spontaneity which poses no strain for either themselves or the audience.

	Addressing audiences
B1	Can give a prepared presentation on a familiar topic within their field, outlining similarities and differences (e.g. between products, countries/regions, plans).
	Can give a prepared straightforward presentation on a familiar topic within their field which is clear enough to be followed without difficulty most of the time, and in which the main points are explained with reasonable precision.
	Can take follow-up questions, but may have to ask for repetition if the delivery is rapid.
A2	Can give a short, rehearsed presentation on a topic pertinent to their everyday life, and briefly give reasons and explanations for opinions, plans and actions.
	Can cope with a limited number of straightforward follow-up questions.
	Can give a short, rehearsed, basic presentation on a familiar subject.
A1	Can answer straightforward follow-up questions if they can ask for repetition and if some help with the formulation of their reply is possible.
A1	Can use a very short prepared text to deliver a rehearsed statement (e.g. to formally introduce someone, to propose a toast).
Pre-A1	No descriptors available

3.2.1.2. Written production

In the categories for written production, the macro-functions “transactional language use” and “evaluative language use” are not separated because they are normally interwoven (“Reading for information and argument” also combined these two aspects). “Creative writing” is the equivalent of “Sustained monologue: describing experience”, and focuses on description and narrative. As an alternative to writing, signers sometimes produce and send a video.⁴²

Overall written production

	Overall written production
C2	Can produce clear, smoothly flowing, complex texts in an appropriate and effective style and a logical structure which helps the reader identify significant points.
C1	Can produce clear, well-structured texts of complex subjects, underlining the relevant salient issues, expanding and supporting points of view at some length with subsidiary points, reasons and relevant examples, and rounding off with an appropriate conclusion.
	Can employ the structure and conventions of a variety of genres, varying the tone, style and register according to addressee, text type and theme.
B2	Can produce clear, detailed texts on a variety of subjects related to their field of interest, synthesising and evaluating information and arguments from a number of sources.
B1	Can produce straightforward connected texts on a range of familiar subjects within their field of interest, by linking a series of shorter discrete elements into a linear sequence.
A2	Can produce a series of simple phrases and sentences linked with simple connectors like “and”, “but” and “because”.
A1	Can give information about matters of personal relevance (e.g. likes and dislikes, family, pets) using simple words/signs and basic expressions.
	Can produce simple isolated phrases and sentences.
Pre-A1	Can give basic personal information (e.g. name, address, nationality), perhaps with the use of a dictionary.

42. The production of formal, signed texts on video is becoming increasingly common. The number of students in the primary, secondary and tertiary education who submit video-recorded assignments in a sign language has been rising rapidly. There are nowadays a number of MA and doctoral dissertations as well as other publications in various genres (e.g. storybooks, textbooks) produced in sign languages. Videoed statements, press releases and public announcements in sign are also increasingly common.

Creative writing

This scale involves personal, imaginative expression in a variety of text types in written and signed modalities. Key concepts operationalised in the scale include the following:

- ▶ aspects described, from simple everyday information, through a variety of subjects related to fields of interest, to engaging stories and descriptions of experience;
- ▶ types of text: from diary entries and short, imaginary biographies and simple poems to well-structured and developed descriptions and imaginative texts;
- ▶ complexity of discourse: from simple words/signs and phrases, through clear connected text, to following established conventions of the genre concerned in clear, well-structured, smoothly flowing text;
- ▶ use of language: from basic vocabulary and simple sentences to an assured, personal, natural style appropriate to both the genre adopted and the reader.

	Creative writing
C2	Can relate clear, smoothly flowing and engaging stories and descriptions of experience in a style appropriate to the genre adopted. Can exploit idiom and humour appropriately to enhance the impact of the text.
C1	Can produce clear, detailed, well-structured and developed descriptions and imaginative texts in an assured, personal, natural style appropriate to the reader in mind. Can incorporate idiom and humour, though use of the latter is not always appropriate. Can give a detailed critical review of cultural events (e.g. plays, films, concerts) or literary works.
B2	Can give clear, detailed descriptions of real or imaginary events and experiences marking the relationship between ideas in clear connected text, and following established conventions of the genre concerned. Can give clear, detailed descriptions on a variety of subjects related to their field of interest. Can give a review of a film, book or play.
B1	Can clearly signal chronological sequence in narrative text. Can give a simple review of a film, book or TV programme using a limited range of language. Can give straightforward, detailed descriptions on a range of familiar subjects within their field of interest. Can give accounts of experiences, describing feelings and reactions in simple, connected text. Can give a description of an event, a recent trip – real or imagined. Can narrate a story.
A2	Can describe everyday aspects of their environment e.g. people, places, a job or study experience in linked sentences. Can give very short, basic descriptions of events, past activities and personal experiences. Can tell a simple story (e.g. about events on a holiday or about life in the distant future). Can produce a series of simple phrases and sentences about their family, living conditions, educational background, or present or most recent job. Can create short, simple imaginary biographies and simple poems about people. Can create diary entries that describe activities (e.g. daily routine, outings, sports, hobbies), people and places, using basic, concrete vocabulary and simple phrases and sentences with simple connectives like “and”, “but” and “because”. Can compose an introduction to a story or continue a story, provided they can consult a dictionary and references (e.g. tables of verb tenses in a course book).
A1	Can produce simple phrases and sentences about themselves and imaginary people, where they live and what they do. Can describe in very simple language what a room looks like. Can use simple words/signs and phrases to describe certain everyday objects (e.g. the colour of a car, whether it is big or small).
Pre-A1	<i>No descriptors available</i>

Reports and essays

This scale covers more formal types of transactional and evaluative writing and signed production. Key concepts operationalised in the scale include the following:

- ▶ content: from familiar subjects of interest and routine factual information to complex academic and professional topics, distinguishing one's own viewpoints from those in the sources;
- ▶ types of text: from short reports and posters to complex texts that present a case, or provide critical appreciation of proposals or literary works;
- ▶ complexity of discourse: from linking sentences with simple connectors to smoothly flowing expositions with effective logical structure.

	Reports and essays
C2	Can produce clear, smoothly flowing, complex reports, articles or essays which present a case, or give critical appreciation of proposals or literary works. Can provide an appropriate and effective logical structure which helps the reader identify significant points. Can set out multiple perspectives on complex academic or professional topics, clearly distinguishing their own ideas and opinions from those in the sources.
C1	Can produce clear, well-structured expositions of complex subjects, underlining the relevant salient issues. Can expand and support points of view at some length with subsidiary points, reasons and relevant examples. Can produce a suitable introduction and conclusion to a longer report, article or dissertation on a complex academic or professional topic provided the topic is within their field of interest and there are opportunities for redrafting and revision.
B2	Can produce an essay or report which develops an argument systematically with appropriate highlighting of significant points and relevant supporting detail. Can produce a detailed description of a complex process. Can evaluate different ideas or solutions to a problem. Can produce an essay or report which develops an argument, giving reasons in support of or against a particular point of view and explaining the advantages and disadvantages of various options. Can synthesise information and arguments from a number of sources.
B1	Can produce short, simple essays on topics of interest. Can produce a text on a topical subject of personal interest, using simple language to list advantages and disadvantages, and give and justify their opinion. Can summarise, report and give their opinion about accumulated factual information on familiar routine and non-routine matters within their field with some confidence. Can produce very brief reports in a standard conventionalised format, which pass on routine factual information and state reasons for actions. Can present a topic in a short report or poster, using photographs and short blocks of text.
A2	Can produce simple texts on familiar subjects of interest, linking sentences with connectors like "and", "because" or "then". Can give their impressions and opinions about topics of personal interest (e.g. lifestyles and culture, stories), using basic everyday vocabulary and expressions.
A1	<i>No descriptors available</i>
Pre-A1	<i>No descriptors available</i>

3.2.2. Production strategies

Communication strategies are presented in the CEFR in relation to the classic approach to strategies in interlanguage communication: planning, execution, monitoring and repair. For production strategies, the execution strategy for which an illustrative scale is offered is "Compensating". Before the appearance of the CEFR, this tended to be the main communication strategy taken into consideration. Monitoring and repair are then combined into one scale.

Planning

This scale is concerned with mental preparation before speaking, signing or writing. It can involve thinking consciously about what to say and how to formulate it; it can also involve rehearsal or the preparation of drafts. Key concepts operationalised in the scale include the following:

- ▶ working out how to express the point that needs to be transmitted, and perhaps rehearsing expression;
- ▶ considering how recipients may react to what is said.

	Planning
C2	<i>No descriptors available; see C1</i>
C1	Can, when preparing a more formal text, consciously adopt the conventions linked to the particular type of text concerned (e.g. structure, level of formality).
B2	Can, in preparing for a potentially complicated or awkward situation, plan what to say in the event of different reactions, reflecting on what expression would be appropriate. Can plan what is to be said and the means to say it, considering the effect on the recipient(s).
B1	Can rehearse and try out new combinations and expressions, inviting feedback. Can work out how to communicate the main point(s) they want to get across, exploiting any resources available and limiting the message to what they can recall or find the means to express.
A2	Can recall and rehearse an appropriate set of phrases from their repertoire.
A1	<i>No descriptors available</i>
Pre-A1	<i>No descriptors available</i>

Compensating

Compensating is a strategy for maintaining communication when one cannot think of the appropriate expression. Key concepts operationalised in the scale include the following:

- ▶ accompanying gestures to support language;
- ▶ deliberately using a “wrong” word/sign and qualifying it;
- ▶ defining the missing concept;
- ▶ paraphrase (circumlocution) and the extent to which such paraphrasing is evident.

	Compensating
C2	Can substitute an equivalent term for a word/sign they can't recall, so smoothly that it is scarcely noticeable.
C1	Can exploit their range of vocabulary options creatively so as to readily and effectively use circumlocution in almost all situations.
B2	Can use circumlocution and paraphrase to cover gaps in vocabulary and structure. Can address most communication problems by using circumlocution, or by avoiding difficult expressions.
B1	Can define the features of something concrete for which they can't remember the word/sign. Can convey meaning by qualifying a word/sign meaning something similar (e.g. a truck for people = bus). Can use a simple word/sign meaning something similar to the concept they want to convey and invite “correction”. Can “foreignise” word/signs in their first language and ask for confirmation.
A2	Can use an inadequate word/sign from their repertoire and use gestures to clarify what they mean. Can identify what they mean by pointing to it (e.g. “I'd like this, please”).
A1	Can use gestures to support simple words/signs in expressing a need.
Pre-A1	Can point to something and ask what it is.

Monitoring and repair

This scale covers both (a) the spontaneous realisation that one has made a slip or run into a problem and (b) the more conscious and perhaps planned process of going back over what has been said and checking it for correctness and appropriateness. Key concepts operationalised in the scale include the following:

- ▶ changing tack and using a different tactic – very obviously at A levels, very smoothly at C levels;
- ▶ self-correcting slips, errors and “favourite mistakes”;
- ▶ the extent to which a communication problem must be evident before repair is undertaken.

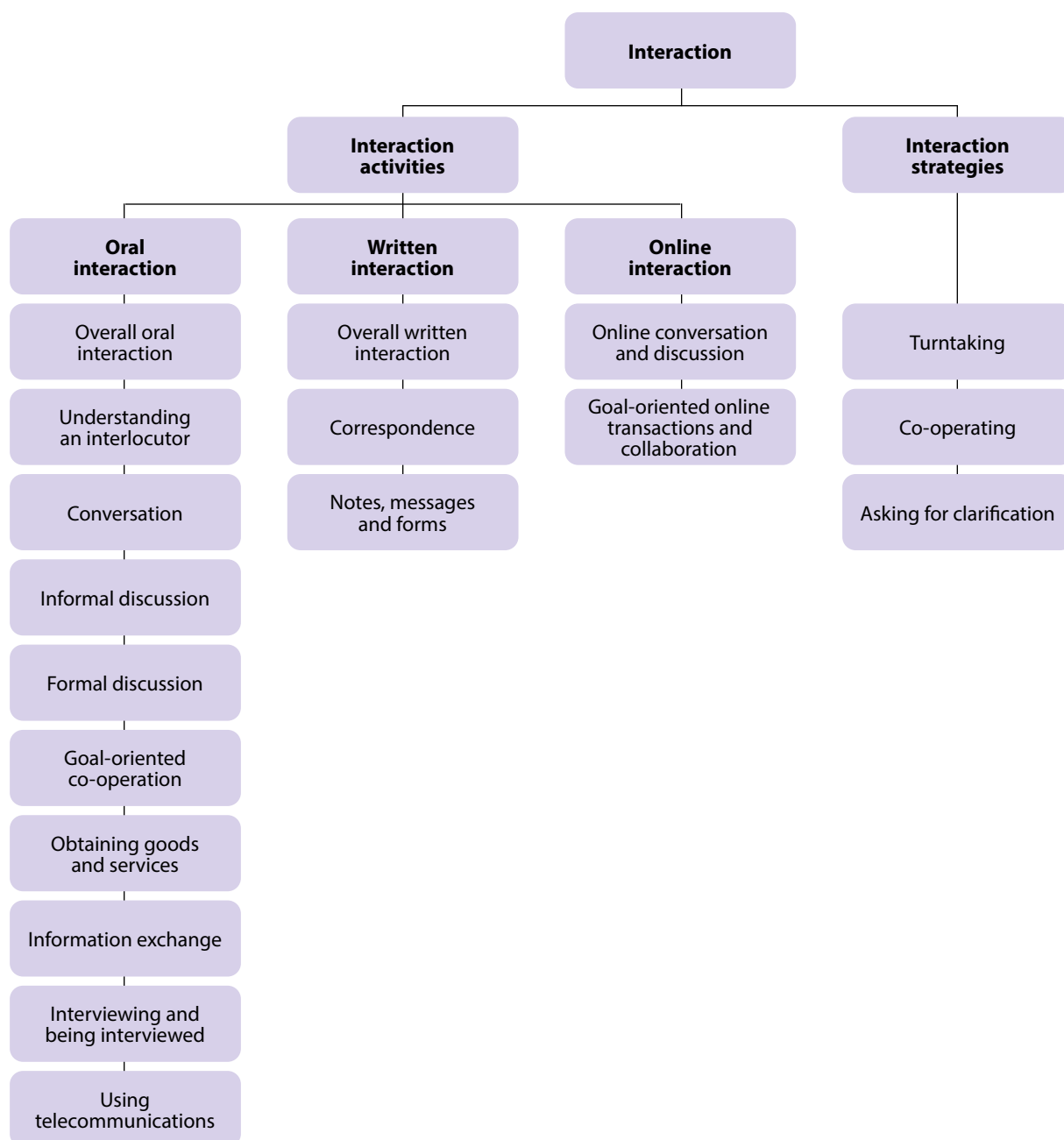
	Monitoring and repair
C2	Can backtrack and restructure around a difficulty so smoothly that the interlocutor is hardly aware of it.
C1	Can backtrack when they encounter a difficulty and reformulate what they want to say without fully interrupting the flow of language. Can self-correct with a high degree of effectiveness.
B2	Can often retrospectively self-correct their occasional “slips” or non-systematic errors and minor flaws in sentence structure. Can correct slips and errors that they become conscious of, or that have led to misunderstandings. Can make a note of their recurring mistakes and consciously monitor for them.
B1	Can correct mix-ups with the marking of time or expressions that lead to misunderstandings, provided the interlocutor indicates there is a problem. Can ask for confirmation that a form used is correct. Can start again using a different tactic when communication breaks down.
A2	<i>No descriptors available</i>
A1	<i>No descriptors available</i>
Pre-A1	<i>No descriptors available</i>

3.3. INTERACTION

Interaction, which involves two or more parties co-constructing discourse, is central in the CEFR scheme of language use summarised at the start of this document. Interpersonal interaction is considered to be the origin of language, with interpersonal, collaborative and transactional functions. Production in the form of storytelling can be considered a further development in oracy and eventually literacy.

Interaction is also fundamental in learning. The CEFR scales for interaction strategies reflect this with scales for turntaking, co-operating (= collaborative strategies) and asking for clarification. These basic interaction strategies are as important in collaborative learning as they are in real-world communication. The majority of the scales for interaction concern oral interaction. When the CEFR was developed, the notion of written interaction did not meet with universal recognition and was not highly developed as a result. With hindsight, one can see that written interaction (= writing much as you would speak, in a slowed-down dialogue) has taken an increasingly significant role over the past 20 years. Rather than further develop that category, however, the new category of online interaction has been developed.

Figure 13 – Interaction activities and strategies



3.3.1. Interaction activities

3.3.1.1. Oral interaction

Oral interaction is understood to include both spoken interaction and live, face-to-face signing. The scales are once again organised by the three macro-functions “interpersonal”, “transactional” and “evaluative”, with certain specialised genres added on. The scales begin with “Understanding an interlocutor”. “Interlocutor” is a somewhat technical term that means the person with whom one is conversing directly in a dialogue. As mentioned before, the metaphor behind the scales for oral comprehension is that of a series of concentric circles. Here we are at the centre of those circles: the user/learner is actively involved in an interaction with the interlocutor.

The other scales then follow:

- ▶ interpersonal: “Conversation”;
- ▶ evaluative: “Informal discussion (with friends)”, “Formal discussion (meetings)”, “Goal-oriented collaboration”;
- ▶ transactional: “Information exchange”, “Obtaining goods and services”, “Interviewing and being interviewed”, and “Using telecommunications”.

Overall oral interaction

	Overall oral interaction
C2	Has a good command of idiomatic expressions and colloquialisms with awareness of connotative levels of meaning. Can convey finer shades of meaning precisely by using, with reasonable accuracy, a wide range of modification devices. Can backtrack and restructure around a difficulty so smoothly that the interlocutor is hardly aware of it.
C1	Can express themselves fluently and spontaneously, almost effortlessly. Has a good command of a broad lexical repertoire allowing gaps to be readily overcome with circumlocutions. There is little obvious searching for expressions or avoidance strategies; only a conceptually difficult subject can hinder a natural, smooth flow of language.
B2	Can use the language fluently, accurately and effectively on a wide range of general, academic, vocational or leisure topics, marking clearly the relationships between ideas. Can communicate spontaneously with good grammatical control without much sign of having to restrict what they want to say, adopting a level of formality appropriate to the circumstances.
	Can interact with a degree of fluency and spontaneity that makes regular interaction, and sustained relationships with users of the target language, quite possible without imposing strain on either party. Can highlight the personal significance of events and experiences, and account for and sustain views clearly by providing relevant explanations and arguments.
B1	Can communicate with some confidence on familiar routine and non-routine matters related to their interests and professional field. Can exchange, check and confirm information, deal with less routine situations and explain why something is a problem. Can express thoughts on more abstract, cultural topics such as films, books, music, etc.
	Can exploit a wide range of simple language to deal with most situations likely to arise while travelling. Can enter unprepared into conversation on familiar topics, and express personal opinions and exchange information on topics that are familiar, of personal interest or pertinent to everyday life (e.g. family, hobbies, work, travel and current events).
A2	Can interact with reasonable ease in structured situations and short conversations, provided the other person helps if necessary. Can manage simple, routine exchanges without undue effort; can ask and answer questions and exchange ideas and information on familiar topics in predictable everyday situations.
	Can communicate in simple and routine tasks requiring a simple and direct exchange of information on familiar and routine matters to do with work and free time. Can handle very short social exchanges but is rarely able to understand enough to keep conversation going of their own accord.
A1	Can interact in a simple way but communication is totally dependent on repetition at a slower rate, rephrasing and repair. Can ask and answer simple questions, initiate and respond to simple statements in areas of immediate need or on very familiar topics.
Pre-A1	Can ask and answer questions about themselves and daily routines, using short, formulaic expressions and relying on gestures to reinforce the information.

Understanding an interlocutor

This scale concerns understanding a person with whom you are conversing directly in an interaction, with the possibility of negotiating meaning. Key concepts operationalised in the scale include the following:

- ▶ topic and setting: from personal details and everyday needs to complex and abstract topics of a specialist nature;
- ▶ type of delivery by the interlocutor: from careful and slow to standard language and less familiar varieties;
- ▶ degree of accommodation by the interlocutor: from sympathetic repetition and taking the trouble to help, to just confirming details if the accent is less familiar.

	Understanding an interlocutor
C2	Can understand any interlocutor, even on abstract and complex topics of a specialist nature beyond their own field, given an opportunity to adjust to a less familiar variety.
C1	Can understand an interlocutor in detail on abstract and complex topics of a specialist nature beyond their own field, though they may need to confirm occasional details, especially if the variety is unfamiliar.
B2	Can understand in detail what is said to them in the standard language or a familiar variety even in a [audially/visually] noisy environment.
B1	Can follow clearly articulated speech/sign directed at them in everyday conversation, though will sometimes have to ask for repetition of particular words/signs and phrases.
A2	Can understand enough to manage simple, routine exchanges without undue effort. Can generally understand clear, standard speech/sign on familiar matters directed at them, provided they can ask for repetition or reformulation from time to time.
	Can understand what is said clearly, slowly and directly to them in simple everyday conversation; can be made to understand, if the interlocutor can take the trouble.
A1	Can understand everyday expressions aimed at the satisfaction of simple needs of a concrete type, delivered directly to them clearly and slowly, with repetition, by a sympathetic interlocutor.
	Can understand questions and instructions addressed carefully and slowly to them and follow short, simple directions.
Pre-A1	Can understand simple questions that directly concern them (e.g. name, age and address), if the person is asking slowly and clearly.
	Can understand simple personal information (e.g. name, age, place of residence, origin) when other people introduce themselves slowly and clearly, directly to them, and can understand questions on this theme addressed to them, though the questions may need to be repeated.
	Can understand a number of familiar words/signs and recognise key information (e.g. numbers, prices, dates and days of the week), provided the delivery is very slow, with repetition if necessary.

Conversation

This scale concerns interaction with a primarily social function: the establishment and maintenance of personal relationships. Key concepts operationalised in the scale include the following:

- ▶ setting: from short exchanges, through maintaining a conversation and sustaining relationships, to flexible use for social purposes;
- ▶ topics: from personal news, through familiar topics of personal interest, to most general topics;
- ▶ language functions: from greetings, etc., through offers, invitations and permission, to degrees of emotion and allusive, joking usage.

	Conversation
C2	Can converse comfortably and appropriately, unhampered by any linguistic limitations in conducting a full social and personal life.
C1	Can use language flexibly and effectively for social purposes, including emotional, allusive and joking usage.
B2	Can establish a relationship with interlocutors through sympathetic questioning and expressions of agreement plus, if appropriate, comments about third parties or shared conditions. Can indicate reservations and reluctance, state conditions when agreeing to requests or granting permission, and ask for understanding of their own position.
	Can engage in extended conversation on most general topics in a clearly participatory fashion, even in a [audially/visually] noisy environment. Can sustain relationships with users of the target language without unintentionally amusing or irritating them or requiring them to behave other than they would with another proficient language user. Can convey degrees of emotion and highlight the personal significance of events and experiences.

	Conversation
B1	Can start up a conversation and help keep it going by asking people relatively spontaneous questions about a special experience or event, expressing reactions and opinions on familiar subjects. Can have relatively long conversations on subjects of common interest, provided the interlocutor makes an effort to support understanding.
	Can enter unprepared into conversations on familiar topics. Can follow clearly articulated language directed at them in everyday conversation, though will sometimes have to ask for repetition of particular words/signs. Can maintain a conversation or discussion but may sometimes be difficult to follow when trying to express exactly what they would like to. Can express and respond to feelings such as surprise, happiness, sadness, interest and indifference.
A2	Can establish social contact (e.g. greetings and farewells, introductions, giving thanks). Can generally understand clear, standard language on familiar matters directed at them, provided they can ask for repetition or reformulation from time to time. Can participate in short conversations in routine contexts on topics of interest. Can express how they feel in simple terms, and express thanks. Can ask for a favour (e.g. to borrow something), can offer a favour, and can respond if someone asks them to do a favour for them.
	Can handle very short social exchanges but is rarely able to understand enough to keep conversation going of their own accord, though they can be made to understand if the interlocutor will take the trouble. Can use simple, everyday, polite forms of greeting and address. Can converse in simple language with peers, colleagues or members of a host family, asking questions and understanding answers relating to most routine matters. Can make and respond to invitations, suggestions and apologies. Can express how they are feeling, using very basic stock expressions. Can state what they like and dislike.
A1	Can understand everyday expressions aimed at the satisfaction of simple needs of a concrete type, delivered directly to them in clear, slow and repeated language by a sympathetic interlocutor. Can take part in a simple conversation of a basic factual nature on a predictable topic (e.g. their home country, family, school). Can make an introduction and use basic greeting and leave-taking expressions. Can ask how people are and react to news.
Pre-A1	Can understand and use basic, formulaic expressions such as "Yes", "No", "Excuse me", "Please", "Thank you", "No thank you", "Sorry". Can recognise simple greetings. Can greet people, state their name and take leave in a simple way.

Informal discussion (with friends)

This scale includes aspects of both the interpersonal and evaluative use of language, since these tend to be interwoven in everyday interaction. Key concepts operationalised in the scale include the following:

- topics: from what to do and where to go, to abstract, complex and even unfamiliar topics and sensitive issues;
- ability to follow the discussion: from identifying the topic, through following the main points, to keeping up with animated discussion and understanding colloquial references;
- language functions: from discussing and (dis)agreeing in a limited way to expressing ideas with precision and dealing diplomatically with disagreement and criticism.

	Informal discussion (with friends)
C2	Can advise on or discuss sensitive issues without awkwardness, understanding colloquial references and dealing diplomatically with disagreement and criticism.
C1	Can easily follow and contribute to complex interactions between third parties in group discussion even on abstract, complex unfamiliar topics.
B2	Can keep up with an animated discussion between proficient users of the target language. Can express their ideas and opinions with precision, and present and respond to complex lines of argument convincingly.
	Can take an active part in informal discussion in familiar contexts, commenting, putting a point of view clearly, evaluating alternative proposals and making and responding to hypotheses. Can with some effort catch much of what is said around them in discussion, but may find it difficult to participate effectively in discussion with several users of the target language who do not modify their language in any way.
	Can account for and sustain their opinions in discussion by providing relevant explanations, arguments and comments.
B1	Can follow much of what is said around them on general topics, provided interlocutors avoid very idiomatic usage and articulate clearly. Can express their thoughts about abstract or cultural topics such as music or films. Can explain why something is a problem. Can give brief comments on the views of others. Can compare and contrast alternatives, discussing what to do, where to go, who or which to choose, etc.
	Can generally follow the main points in an informal discussion with friends provided they articulate clearly in standard language or a familiar variety. Can give or seek personal views and opinions in discussing topics of interest. Can make their opinions and reactions understood as regards solutions to problems or practical questions of where to go, what to do, or how to organise an event (e.g. an outing). Can express beliefs, opinions and agreement and disagreement politely.
A2	Can generally identify the topic of discussion around them when it is conducted slowly and clearly. Can exchange opinions and compare things and people using simple language. Can discuss what to do in the evening or at the weekend. Can make and respond to suggestions. Can agree and disagree with others.
	Can discuss everyday practical issues in a simple way when addressed clearly, slowly and directly. Can discuss what to do, where to go and make arrangements to meet. Can express opinions in a limited way.
A1	Can exchange likes and dislikes for sports, foods, etc., using a limited repertoire of expressions, when addressed clearly, slowly and directly.
Pre-A1	No descriptors available

Formal discussion (meetings)

This scale is concerned with more formal discussion, mainly in a professional or academic context. Key concepts operationalised in the scale are very similar to those in informal discussion, but also include the following:

- ▶ type of meeting and topics: from exchanges on practical problems to discussion of abstract, complex, unfamiliar issues;
- ▶ ability to follow the discussion: from needing repetition and clarification to understanding points given prominence and keeping up with animated debate;
- ▶ ability to contribute: from needing to rehearse and get help with formulation to probing, evaluating and challenging the contributions of others and arguing one's own position convincingly.

	Formal discussion (meetings)
C2	Can hold their own in formal discussion of complex issues, putting an articulate and persuasive argument, at no disadvantage to other participants. Can advise on/handle complex, delicate or contentious issues, provided they have the necessary specialised knowledge. Can deal with hostile questioning confidently, hold on to the turn and diplomatically rebut counter-arguments.
C1	Can easily keep up with the debate, even on abstract, complex, unfamiliar topics. Can argue a formal position convincingly, responding to questions and comments and answering complex lines of counter-argument fluently, spontaneously and appropriately. Can restate, evaluate and challenge contributions from other participants about matters within their academic or professional competence. Can make critical remarks or express disagreement diplomatically. Can follow up questions by probing for more detail and can reformulate questions if these are misunderstood.
B2	Can keep up with an animated discussion, identifying accurately arguments supporting and opposing points of view. Can use appropriate technical terminology when discussing their area of specialisation with other specialists. Can express their ideas and opinions with precision, and present and respond to complex lines of argument convincingly.
B1	Can participate actively in routine and non-routine formal discussion. Can follow the discussion on matters related to their field, understand in detail the points given prominence. Can contribute, account for and sustain their opinion, evaluate alternative proposals and make and respond to hypotheses.
B1	Can follow much of what is said that is related to their field, provided interlocutors avoid very idiomatic usage and articulate clearly. Can put over a point of view clearly, but has difficulty engaging in debate.
A2	Can take part in routine formal discussion of familiar subjects which is clearly articulated in the standard form of the language or a familiar variety and which involves the exchange of factual information, receiving instructions or the discussion of solutions to practical problems. Can follow argumentation and discussion on a familiar or predictable topic, provided the points are made in relatively simple language and/or repeated, and opportunity is given for clarification.
A2	Can generally follow changes of topic in formal discussion related to their field which is conducted slowly and clearly. Can exchange relevant information and give their opinion on practical problems when asked directly, provided they receive some help with formulation and can ask for repetition of key points if necessary.
A2	Can express what they think about things when addressed directly in a formal meeting, provided they can ask for repetition of key points if necessary.
A1	<i>No descriptors available</i>
Pre-A1	<i>No descriptors available</i>

Goal-oriented co-operation

This scale concerns collaborative, task-focused work, which is a daily occurrence in real life, especially in professional contexts. As with the conversation and discussion scales, this scale includes similar descriptors on the ability to follow discussion. Key concepts operationalised in the scale include the following:

- ▶ following the discussion: from understanding simple instructions explained directly to them to understanding detailed instructions reliably;
- ▶ active contribution to the work: from simply asking for things and giving things to speculating about causes and consequences and organising the entire task.